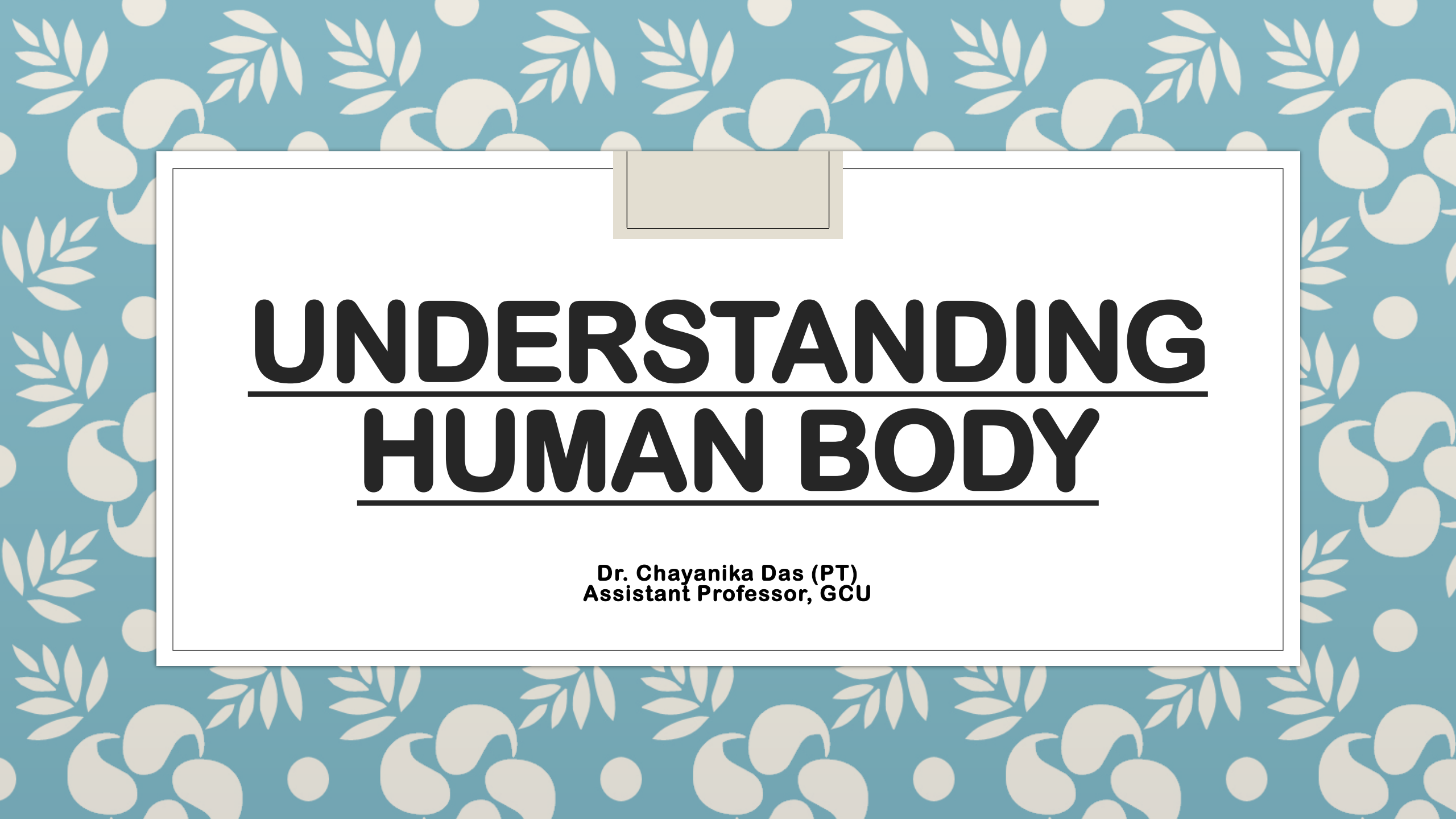




UNDERSTANDING **HUMAN BODY**

Dr. Chayanika Das (PT)
Assistant Professor, GCU

INTRODUCTION

- **Charaka**, a Kashmiri sage , is known as the “**Father of Ayurvedic medicine**”.
- Ayurveda is the most ancient and renowned system of medicine in India.
- Ayurveda is made from two words “ Ayus “ means life and “Ved” means knowledge.
- Ayurveda means the study of life . It takes a natural approach of health and well – being.

8 BRANCHES OF AYURVEDA

- Kaya Chikitsa – Medicine
- Shalya Tantra – Surgery
- Shalakya Tantra – ENT & Ophthalmology
- Kaumarbhrtya – Paediatrics and Obstetrics
- Agada Tantra – Toxicology
- Bhut Vidya – Psychiatry
- Rasayan – Rejuvenation therapy and geriatrics
- Vajikaran - Sexology

OBJECTIVES OF AYURVEDA

- To maintain the health of a healthy person.
- To cure the health issue of a diseased person.
- To live gracefully and harmoniously in balance of body, mind and spirit.

AYURVEDIC TREATMENT TECHNIQUES

- a) Dietary change
- b) Herbal medicine , including combining herbs with metals or gems that can take the form of pellets, tablets and powder of various colours and scents.
- c) Breathing exercises
- d) Sound therapy, including mantras
- e) Yoga
- f) Ayurveda claims to treat a range of disorders or diseases such as anxiety, asthma , arthritis, digestive problems, high BP, Stress etc.

PANCHA MAHA BHUTA ON INTERNAL ENVIRONMENT OF HUMAN BEING

- Pancha maha Bhuta consists of three words : “pancha” means five , “maha” means great and “Bhuta” means elements or something.
- According to yoga and ayurveda , all living and non living things in the universe are made up of this pancha maha Bhuta , more commonly known as the 5 fundamental elements of life . They are:

1) Air (Vayu) , 2) Water (Jal), 3) Fire (Agni), 4) Earth (Bhumi), 5) Space (Aakash)

Panchamahabhutas are directly associated with the health system of human beings.

The presence of the pancha maha bhutas in the human body corresponds as follows :

- 1) **Aaksh mahabhuta (space)** is present in the voids in the human body such as the nostrils, mouth and abdomen. It helps in completing the process of transportation and communication.
- 2) **Vayu mahabhuta (air)** represents the gaseous form of matter present in the body. It also includes the energy formed by the several movements within the body like heartbeat, inspiration and expiration.
- 3) **Jal mahabhuta (water)** is present in all body fluids including saliva, plasma , and digestive juices.
- 4) **Bhumi mahabhuta (earth)** is represented in the structure of the body, including the bones, teeth, flesh and hair.

These 5 elements exist in the body in combination in the form of doshas, dhatus and malas.

- Doshas such as Vata, pita & kapha
- Sapta dhatus
- Trimalas (Purusha, Mootra, Sweda)

TRI –DOSHA THEORY

- The word dosha means impurity or imbalance. The central concept of Ayurvedic medicine is the theory that health exists when there is a balance between these fundamental bodily humours or doshas called **Vata (air & space) , Pitta and Kapha**.
- The three body humours are :
 - 1) **Vata** : it is the air principle necessary to mobilize the functions of the nervous system, brain functions and sensory organs. Functions : motor functions, breathing natural urges , nerve impulse.
 - 2) **Pitta** : it is the fire principle which uses bile to direct digestion and hence metabolism into the venous system. Functions : body heat, temperature, digestion, anger.
 - 3) **Kapha** : it is the water principle which related to the mucous, lubrication and the carrier of nutrients into the arterial system. Functions : lubrication, stability energy.
- When vata is disturbed it causes illness, weakness, constipation, insomnia.
- When pitta is excess it causes yellow color of stool, urine, eyes.
- When kapha is excess it causes nausea, lethargy, difficulty in breathing.

SAPTA DHATU

1. Rasa – Plasma
2. Rakta – Blood
3. Mamsa – Muscles
4. Meda – Fat
5. Asthi – Bones
6. Majja – Bone marrow
7. Shukra – Sperms and ovum

MALA (EXCRETORY MATERIALS)

- **Mala** :

Excretion of the waste matter is as important as ingestion and digestion. As one eats and digests daily. It is also necessary to release the unwanted, unnecessary and unrequired by – products of the metabolic functions time to time. This waste that comes out at regular intervals is referred to as “ MALA” in Ayurveda.

- **Two types of Mala** :

- 1) **Sharira Mala** : Waste products of physical body such as Pureesh (stool); Mutra (urine); and Sweda (Sweat).
- 2) **Dhatu Mala** : Waste products from the metabolism of tissues.

PRAKRUTI

- The term Prakruti is a Sanskrit word that means “nature” , “creativity” or “the first creation”.
- According to Ayurveda , Prakruti or the characteristics of an individual is determined by a combination of the three Doshas – Vata , Pitta , and Kapha.
- **Types of Prakruti :**
 - 1) Sharirika Prakruti
 - 2) Manasika Prakruti
- **There are 7 types of Sharirika Prakruti :**
 - 1) Vata prakruti
 - 2) Pitta prakruti
 - 3) Kapha prakruti
 - 4) Vata pitta prakruti
 - 5) Pitta kapha prakruti
 - 6) Kapha vata prakriti
 - 7) Tridosha

To maintain or to have a balanced body and mind or to maintain balance in the dosha there are various ayurvedic and yogic techniques available . They are :

- Herbal remedies
- Yoga
- Pranayama
- Meditation

DIAGNOSIS

- “Nidana sthana” concerned with the diagnosis of disease.
- Recording of pulse is very important in ayurvedic diagnosis.
- Treatment
- Shodhana Karma / Panchakarma (elimination of morbid factors).
- Shaman karma (palliative treatment).

DRUG FORMULATION THERAPY

- For formulation and assessment of action of the drugs , the theory of ***rasa-guna-virya-vipaka-prabhava***
- Rasa – therapeutically active agent.
- Guna – quality
- Virya – an active principle by which potency is characterized.
- Vipaka – end product of digestion.

THANK YOU